



FOCUS ON... **LEAD**

Easy to purify and simple to shape, lead has been in use for 9,000 years.



▲ Lead does not rust, so sheets of this metal are used to waterproof roofs.



▲ The green glaze on this ancient ceramic model of a pigsty comes from lead compounds.

► High-quality crystal glasses sparkle in the light because lead oxide is added to the glass.



Lead

82
Pb

The symbol for this metal is taken from the Latin word “plumbum”, from where the word “plumber” also originates. This is because in ancient Roman plumbing, lead was used to make water pipes. Today, we know that pure lead is poisonous, so it is seldom used for pipes. One common use of lead is in car batteries.

ATOMIC MASS 207.2

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY
Prehistoric

This ore is found in the form of long crystals.

Red crystals of crocoite, an ore of lead

